BEYOND EVALUATION USE

Voicing Variables Activity Instructions

It often helps to know something about your participants prior to beginning a training session. This activity is a brief introductory activity that allows you and the participants to get to know a little about one another's backgrounds and interests as they relate to multi-site evaluations.

Begin by asking participants to stand whenever they hear a description or characteristic that applies to them. When you and the participants have glanced around the room at those standing, you may instruct the group to sit. Next, ask participants to stand if the next trait applies to them. The traits you ask about are related to a broader theme or question and should be asked in an order that is easy for any participant to anticipate. Examples are provided on the following page. Feel free to modify the characteristics to suit your audience.

It is often helpful for the trainer to offer congratulatory or encouraging comments to participants as they stand, especially for some characteristics. For example, when asking participants to stand *"…If this is your first time at this conference*," it sets a positive tone in the session to welcome these participants to the conference and ask others in the room to do so.

If you have questions or would like to see this activity demonstrated, you may watch the video of the Making the Most of Multi-site Evaluations workshop found at http://www.cehd.umn.edu/projects/beu/default.html

Example: Voicing Variables for Multi-site Workshop

Variable	Options
Where do you currently live?	• Twin Cities • MN • Midwest USA • Other parts of USA • Other North America • Other parts of the world
How many times have you attended this conference?	• This is my first time • Twice • Three times • Four or more times
How long have you been an evaluator?	• Less than a year • 1-3 years • 4-7 years • 8 or more years
What fields have you conducted evaluations in?	• Education • STEM education • Health • Social service • Government • Other (please say)
Have you ever participated in a large, government-funded evaluation study?	• Yes • No
How many multi-site evaluations have you participated in?	• None • 1-2 • 3-4 • Five or more
In the multi-site evaluations you participated in, what were the sites like?	• Sites were the same, implementing the same thing • Sites were different, implementing different programs
What was the number of sites in the largest multisite you participated in?	• Five or fewer • Six to 15 • Sixteen to 30 • More than 30